

Name: _____ Date: _____ Block: _____

The Namesake | chapter 5 close reading

Directions: Develop responses to the following questions and, where indicated, be sure to include embedded quotations to support your analysis.

“... a suicide had been committed, a person had jumped in front of the train. He is shocked and discomfited by the news, feeling bad about his irritation and impatience, wondering if the victim had been a man or a woman, young or old. He imagines the person consulting the same schedule that's in his backpack, determining exactly when the train would be passing through. The approach of the train's headlights. As a result of the delay he misses his commuter rail connection in Boston, waits another forty minutes for the next one. He puts a call through to his parents' house, but no one answers. He tries his father's department at the university, but there too the phone rings and rings. At the station he sees his father waiting on the darkened platform, wearing sneakers and corduroys, anxiousness in his face. A trench coat is belted around his waist, a scarf knitted by Ashima wrapped at his throat, a tweed cap on his head” (Lahiri 121/130).

1. Why would Lahiri choose to have this suicide occur just prior to Ashoke's conversation with Gogol in the car?

2. How can this passage connect to Gogol's decision to live as Nikhil?

3. Note Lahiri's use of imagery in her description of Ashoke. Which piece of imagery seems the most significant? Why? **Be sure to include a properly cited and embedded quotation.**

4. This chapter includes more than one train journey. How can this relate to Gogol's character development in Chapter 5?

5. Given Ashoke's revelations to Gogol at the end of Chapter 5, do you think Gogol should abandon his new name? Explain your opinion.
